JAYAPRAKASH NARAYAN

1902–1979



“THOSE WHO OCCUPY HIGH PLACES IN SOCIETY—IN POLITICS, BUSINESS, THE PROFESSIONS—BEAR THE HEAVY RESPONSIBILITY OF LEADING THE PEOPLE BY PERSONAL EXAMPLE.”

Jayaprakash Narayan was a socialist, an admirer of Gandhi, and a prominent figure in the nationalist movement. He quit politics in 1954 to work more directly for the welfare of the poor. A persuasive public speaker, he spoke out against political and bureaucratic corruption during the Indira Gandhi regime, and was imprisoned for leading a hugely popular resistance movement against her government. He subsequently helped form the Janata Party, which defeated the Congress in the 1977 elections and formed the first ever non-Congress government since Independence.

SOCIALISM

Socialism is a way of organizing people and resources so that the gap between the rich and the poor is very small or non-existent. In a